

Active Directory Lab – Part 4: Group Policy Configuration

Objective

The objective of this lab was to practise basic Group Policy configuration in an Active Directory domain. This included creating and applying a login banner policy, configuring account lockout settings, and verifying that the Group Policy Objects were applied successfully.

Lab Environment

This part of the lab used the adlab.local domain created in the previous stages. The Windows Server virtual machine was acting as the domain controller, and Group Policy Management was used to configure domain-based policies.

The policies were applied within the adlab.local domain.

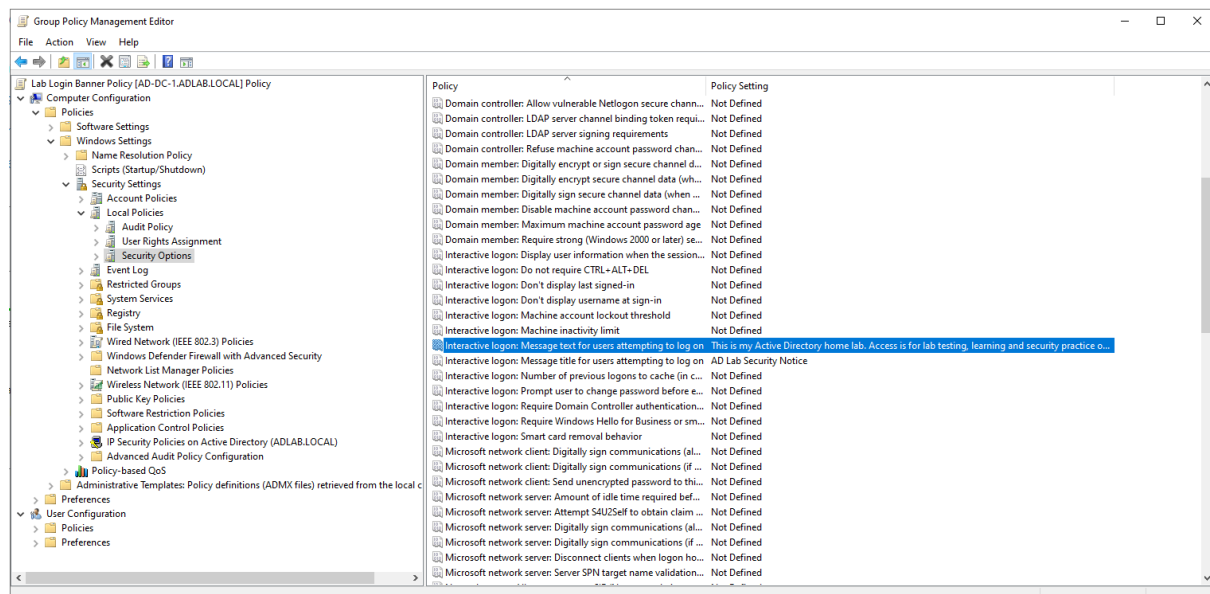
Tools Used:

- Windows Server 2022 Evaluation
- Group Policy Management
- Group Policy Management Editor
- Command Prompt

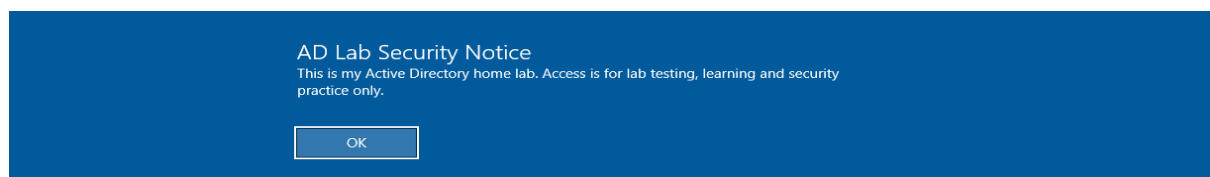
Steps Performed

Group Policy Management was opened on the domain controller. A new Group Policy Object was created for the login banner and linked to the adlab.local domain.

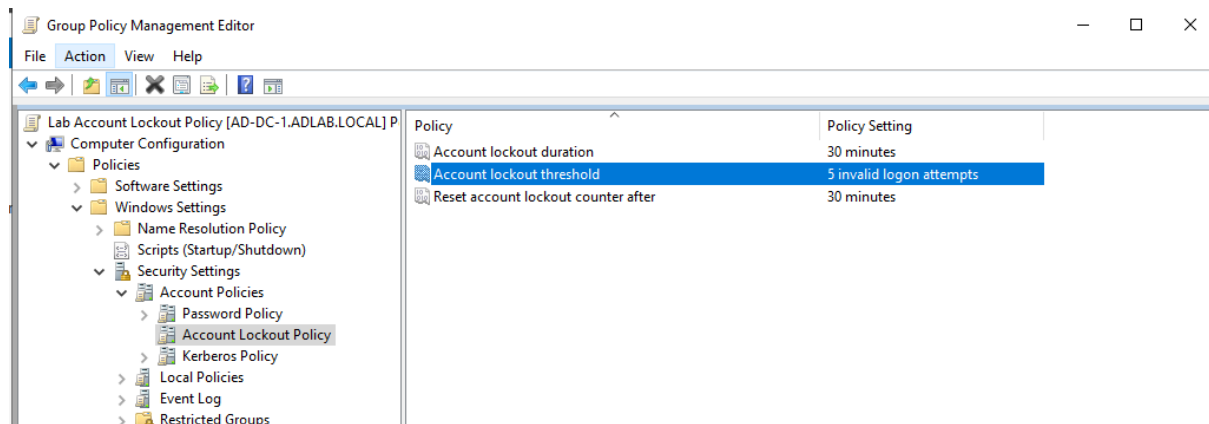
The login banner policy was configured under Security Options. The message title and message text were edited so that a notice would appear before users logged in.



The policy was then applied and tested by restarting the system. After reboot, the login banner appeared successfully before the sign-in screen.



Account lockout settings were configured through Group Policy. The policy was configured with a lockout threshold of 5 invalid logon attempts, a lockout duration of 30 minutes, and a reset counter of 30 minutes.



Command Prompt was used to verify that the Group Policy Objects had applied. The “gpresult /r” command showed both the login banner policy and account lockout policy under Applied Group Policy Objects.

```
C:\Users\Administrator>gpresult /r

Microsoft (R) Windows (R) Operating System Group Policy Result tool v2.0
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Created on 7/21/2026 at 8:08:00 AM

RSOP data for ADLAB\Administrator on AD-DC-1 : Logging Mode
-----

OS Configuration:      Primary Domain Controller
OS Version:            10.0.20348
Site Name:             Default-First-Site-Name
Roaming Profile:       N/A
Local Profile:         C:\Users\Administrator
Connected over a slow link?: No

COMPUTER SETTINGS
-----
CN=AD-DC-1,OU=Domain Controllers,DC=adlab,DC=local
Last time Group Policy was applied: 7/21/2026 at 8:07:40 AM
Group Policy was applied from:    AD-DC-1.adlab.local
Group Policy slow link threshold: 500 kbps
Domain Name:                     ADLAB
Domain Type:                     Windows 2008 or later

Applied Group Policy Objects
-----
Default Domain Controllers Policy
Default Domain Policy
Lab Login Banner Policy
Lab Account Lockout Policy
```

Findings

The login banner policy was configured successfully and appeared before user sign-in. This confirmed that the Group Policy setting had applied correctly.

The account lockout policy was also configured with a threshold of 5 invalid logon attempts and a 30-minute lockout duration. This provided a basic security control for repeated failed login attempts.

Conclusion

This part of the lab demonstrated how Group Policy can be used to configure security-related settings in an Active Directory environment. A login banner was created and successfully displayed, and account lockout settings were configured to support basic account protection. These are common administration tasks in IT support, service desk, and Windows system administration environments.